A-A-51258A
3 August 1987
SUPERCEDES
A-A-51258
9 December 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBE, CAPILLARY, MICRO-HEMATOCRIT

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-T-36487B dated 12 June 1978 and Federal Specification NNN-T-1499A dated 15 April 1978.

This Commercial Item Description covers requirements for plain and heparin-coated capillary tubes for use in micro-hematocrit procedures.

Salient characteristics:

Capillary tubes covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified for the appropriate stock number and item identification:

Type I - Heparinized
Type II - Plain

Capillary tubes of both types shall be clean, transparent and fabricated of soda-lime or borosilicate glass, suitable for the purpose intended. The length of the tube shall be 75 ± 2.0 mm. Wall thickness shall be 0.20 ± 0.03 mm. Inside diameter shall be from 1.1 - 1.2 mm. Bore of the tube shall be uniform and not vary in excess of ± 0.025 mm in 75 mm.

Capillary tubes shall be straight and open at both ends without lip or obstruction. Tube shall be cut at 90 degrees to tube axis and shall not have sharp, chipped or jagged ends. Tube shall be capable of drawing up blood to a level within 2 cm. from the top end.

Type I. Inner surface of Type I shall be uniformly coated with minimum of 3.0 U.S.P. units of Heparin. Heparin shall be the ammonium salt isolated from pork lung, liver, intestinal mucosa, or beef lung or liver. For the purpose of identification, each tube of Type I shall be color coded with red tip or band.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type II. Type II tube shall be plain and free of foreign material. Tube shall be clean and dry and ready for use. For the purpose of identification, each tube of Type II shall be color coded with blue tip or band.

Workmanship. Tubes shall be clean, dry and free of foreign material at time of delivery and before coating for Type I, and shall be free of other defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred tubes of one type only, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspections. Inspections, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for inspections. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with acceptable commercial practice.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Capillary test. (for Type I and II). Held in a horizontal position, the sample capillary tubes shall be tested in accordance with currently accepted technique for hematocrit determination. The level to which the blood is drawn up within a 30 second period shall be noted.

Fluidity test. (for Type I only) The test shall be conducted by initially preparing recalcified sheep plasma by the following two step or equivalent process.

(a) Sheep plasma preparation. Sheep plasma shall be prepared in accordance with USP Assay for Sodium Heparin.

(b) Recalcify sheep plasma. To 10 milliliters (ml) of the prepared sheep plasma shall be added 2.0 ml of the 1.0% calcium chloride solution used in the heparin assay. The sheep plasma and calcium chloride solution shall be mixed well.

Heparin Content. (for Type I only) The Heparin content shall be determined by the method of assaying Sodium Heparin in the latest edition of USP. The result obtained shall represent the Heparin content on the inner surfaces of the tubes. No Heparin from the outside surface shall enter the test sample. Tubes shall contain a minimum of 3.0 USP units.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6640-00-618-0072	Type I
6640-00-618-0073	Type II

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6640-1418

Location: NCR Disk #3

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4956 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51258A	TUBE, CAPILLARY, MICRO-HEMATOCRIT

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.